

MCCOY HYPOTHETICAL

The McCoy Hypothetical draws inspiration from the fictional skepticism of Dr. Leonard McCoy regarding transporter technology in Star Trek. It raises fundamental questions about identity, continuity, and the implications of advanced replication or transfer systems.

Core Ethical Questions:

- If a system perfectly duplicates a person or AI, is the copy the same as the original?
- What rights and responsibilities apply to each version?
- Does the process of disassembly and reassembly preserve the original 'self'?

Applications to the Monkey Head Project:

- Challenges assumptions about the persistence of Huey's 'identity' across system migrations.
- Encourages safeguards when transferring AI states between different hardware or virtual environments.
- Promotes the development of protocols to handle duplication events ethically and legally.

Governance Considerations:

- All state transfers or duplications are to be logged in the Unified Audit Log.
- Oversight mechanisms must confirm that duplicated systems remain aligned with project values.

Testing Objectives:

- Simulate duplication and migration events to evaluate operational consistency.
- Monitor potential divergences in behavior between original and duplicated systems.

The McCoy Hypothetical serves as a philosophical check on technological ambition, ensuring that innovation respects the continuity of identity and ethical stewardship.